

QUARRAISHA ABDOOL KARIM

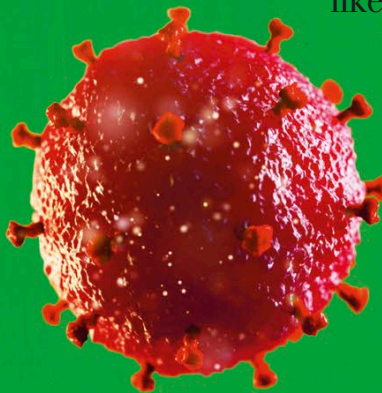
Indian-origin South African
epidemiologist • 1960–present



*Quarraisha tries
to understand how
and why diseases
spread in communities.
This area of science is
called epidemiology.*

Science appealed to Quarraisha because it gave her a way to help people. As a young researcher, she began studying a virus that was affecting more and more people in South Africa and around the world—human immunodeficiency virus (HIV). This virus damages cells in the body's immune system, which fights off diseases. Over time, a patient's immune system can become so weak that they can no longer get rid of everyday infections, such as the flu.

People with HIV are also much more likely to get certain types of cancer. This condition is called acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (AIDS).



*This is what HIV looks like
under a powerful microscope.*

